

The GI-MAP Guide

BabyBird Physique | Wesnoski Coaching

What the GI-MAP is

The GI-MAP is an at-home stool test that shows what's living in your gut and how well your gut is working. It's run by Diagnostic Solutions Laboratory and is one of the most widely used stool tests in functional health.

It reads DNA. The test uses qPCR to find the specific DNA of bacteria, yeast, parasites and viruses. Standard stool tests often rely on growing a culture or looking under a microscope, which can miss organisms that are hard to grow or present in small amounts.

It measures amounts, not just yes or no. You see how much of each organism is there, so your coach or provider can spot overgrowths and imbalances, not only infections.

It's one sample, collected at home. The kit includes everything you need, and the sample ships back at room temperature.

Signs your gut might be the missing piece

Gut problems don't always show up as stomach problems. If several of these sound like you, a GI-MAP may be worth talking about with your provider or coach.

Bloating, gas or discomfort after meals, even with "clean" food

Constipation, loose stools, or swinging between the two

Food sensitivities that keep growing

Low energy or brain fog that sleep doesn't fix

Skin issues like acne, eczema or rashes

Stubborn fat loss despite a solid plan

Bloodwork showing low iron, low B12 or inflammation with no clear cause

Autoimmune or thyroid issues

Symptoms that started after antibiotics, food poisoning or travel

Any of these can have other causes too. That's why testing beats guessing.

What it tests

The report has two halves: what's living in your gut, and how well your gut is doing its job.

What's living in your gut

Section	What it looks for	Why it matters
Pathogens	Bacteria, viruses and parasites that cause infection	Can drive diarrhea, cramping and ongoing gut stress
H. pylori	A stomach bacteria, plus its virulence factors	Linked to reflux, low stomach acid and poor protein and mineral absorption
Normal bacterial flora	Your beneficial "good" bacteria	Low levels can mean weaker digestion, immunity and gut lining support
Opportunistic bacteria	Bacteria that cause trouble when they overgrow	Often tied to bloating, inflammation and food reactions
Fungi and yeast	Candida and other yeasts	Overgrowth can show up as cravings, bloating, brain fog and skin issues
Parasites	Protozoa and worms	Can cause gut symptoms, fatigue and nutrient loss

How well your gut is working

Marker	What it shows
Elastase	How much digestive enzyme your pancreas is putting out
Steatocrit	Fat left in your stool, a sign of how well you're digesting fats
Beta-glucuronidase	An enzyme that can recycle estrogen and toxins back into your body
Occult blood	Hidden blood in your stool that you can't see
Secretory IgA	Your gut's front-line immune defense
Anti-gliadin IgA	Your gut's immune reaction to gluten
Eosinophil activation protein	Immune activity often tied to allergies, food reactions or parasites
Calprotectin	Inflammation in the gut lining

Optional add-ons include zonulin (a "leaky gut" marker), a gluten exposure test, and antibiotic resistance genes.

How to prep for the test

What you take before the test can hide what's really going on. Never stop a prescription without talking to your doctor first.

What	When to stop	Why
Antibiotics	Wait 2 weeks after finishing, with your prescriber's guidance	They wipe out bacteria and skew the results

What	When to stop	Why
Oral steroids or immune suppressants	For prednisone, wait 2 weeks after finishing. Other prescriptions continue unless your prescriber advises otherwise	They can mask immune and inflammation markers
Antimicrobial herbs and supplements	Initial test: 2 weeks before. Retest: 4 weeks before	They can knock down organisms you're trying to find
Probiotics	Spore- or soil-based: 2 weeks before. Regular probiotics: 3 days before	Gives a true baseline instead of a reading of the supplement
Ox bile or lipase enzymes	3 days before	They change the fat digestion readings
Biofilm disruptors	For retesting: 4 weeks before	Ask your coach
Aspirin	Anti-inflammatory medicines: 2 weeks before, only with your prescriber's approval	Can affect the hidden blood marker
Colonoscopy or barium enema	Wait at least 4 weeks after	The prep clears out your gut

Keep taking your prescription medications unless your doctor tells you otherwise.

Before you collect

For initial testing, also discuss stopping bismuth 2 weeks before collection and other gut-specific supplements, including digestive supports and gut-healing formulas, 3 days before collection.

For the 3 days before collection, follow your coach's instructions to eat 70-100 g of fat per day. If assessing your response to gluten, discuss the preparation with your provider before changing your intake.

Do not collect while menstruating. Write your name and date of birth on the vial and ship the sample as soon as possible using your kit's instructions.

These timings distinguish an initial test from a retest. Confirm your preparation with your coach and prescribing clinician. Do not stop or change prescription medication on your own.

Why the order matters

Finding something on a GI-MAP is step one. Jumping straight into a harsh cleanse or "kill" protocol on an inflamed gut is how people flare up and quit. The R3 System works in order:

1. Regulate. Calm inflammation and stress first, so your body is ready to handle gut work.
2. Repair. Support digestion and the gut lining, then go after overgrowths and pathogens when your markers say you're ready.
3. Rebuild. Bring back healthy bacteria and lock in the habits that keep your gut stable.

Your results decide where you start. Not everyone needs the same protocol, and retesting shows whether it's working.

Important

This guide is for education only. It isn't medical advice and doesn't diagnose or treat anything. Talk to your physician before stopping any medication or starting a protocol.

Want help with your gut?

A GI-MAP is only as useful as the plan that follows it. If your gut has been holding you back, book a quick call to see if coaching is the right fit.

Sources

GI-MAP overview and product brief from Diagnostic Solutions Laboratory. Follow the preparation agreed with your coach and prescribing clinician.

Work with Jimmy: <https://info.wesnoskicoaching.com/jimmy-application>